



ANALYSIS AND PREDICTION OF WEATHER PATTERNS USING SATELLITE OBSERVATIONS AND MACHINE LEARNING MODELS

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Under the Guidance of
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Problem Statement

Problem

- High-end **NWP models** are computationally expensive and fail to capture localized monsoon volatility in Kolkata

Opportunity

- Big data and advanced machine learning offer modern alternatives to capture intricate, non-linear atmospheric patterns.

Solution

- We leverage **NASA's MERRA-2 and GPM satellite observations** paired with a two-stage Gradient Boosting pipeline

Objectives

Analyse Local Weather Data

Feature Pipeline Engineering

Dual-Stage GBM Architecture for predicating weather pattern



Literature Review

Ref No.	Year	Authors	Paper	Research	Gaps
[1]	2024	D. Sharma, P. Rattan	Rainfall Prediction using Random Forest and XGBoost -A comparative study	• Compared Random Forest (RF) and XGBoost using a 10-year NASA dataset (2012–2022) for the Jammu Region. • RF performed slightly better on test data with a lower RMSE (3.799).	• Significant overfitting noted (large gap between training and validation error).



Ref No.	Year	Authors	Paper	Research	Gaps
[2]	2024	Jagadeshwari Puttanapura, Monika Singh, C.K.K Reddy, Srinath Doss	Improved Prediction of Rainfall using Random Forest Classifier Over Taiwan	- Evaluated 9 ML/DL algorithms (including LSTM, SVM, ANN) on a 20-year weather dataset for Taiwan Random Forest outperformed others	Evaluated rainfall only as a binary/multi-class classification target rather than predicting exact quantitative volume (<i>mm/hr</i>).
[3]	2025	A. Jain, G. Sharma	Enhancing Weather Prediction Accuracy with Gradient Boosting: A Machine Learning Approach	- Compared 6 classifiers (KNN, SVM, Naive Bayes, Decision Tree, Gradient Boosting, XGBoost) on a Seattle dataset XGBoost reached 87.90% accuracy	Highly dependent on a single regional dataset, restricting model generalizability to highly volatile monsoon zones like India



Ref No.	Year	Authors	Paper	Research	Gaps
[4]	2025	P. Sahu, S. Kumar, R. K. Yadav, et al.	Explainable AI-Powered and Machine Learning Approach for Heavy Rainfall Prediction	- Developed a hybrid Voting Classifier Ensemble - Used SHAP and LIME for model transparency and feature importance tracking.	Complex ensemble approach requires high computational footprint and lacks real-time sequential multi-step timeline adjustments.
[5]	2024	S. P. S. Ibrahim, N. V. Harika, et al	Application of Machine Learning and Data Mining Techniques for Accurate Cloud Burst Prediction	- Utilized Fuzzy Association Rule Mining - Handled severe class imbalances to achieve a baseline 94% accuracy.	The data mining rules struggle when handling datasets with significantly high spatial or temporal density variances.

Table-1

Flow Chart: Data and Logic Flow Through the System

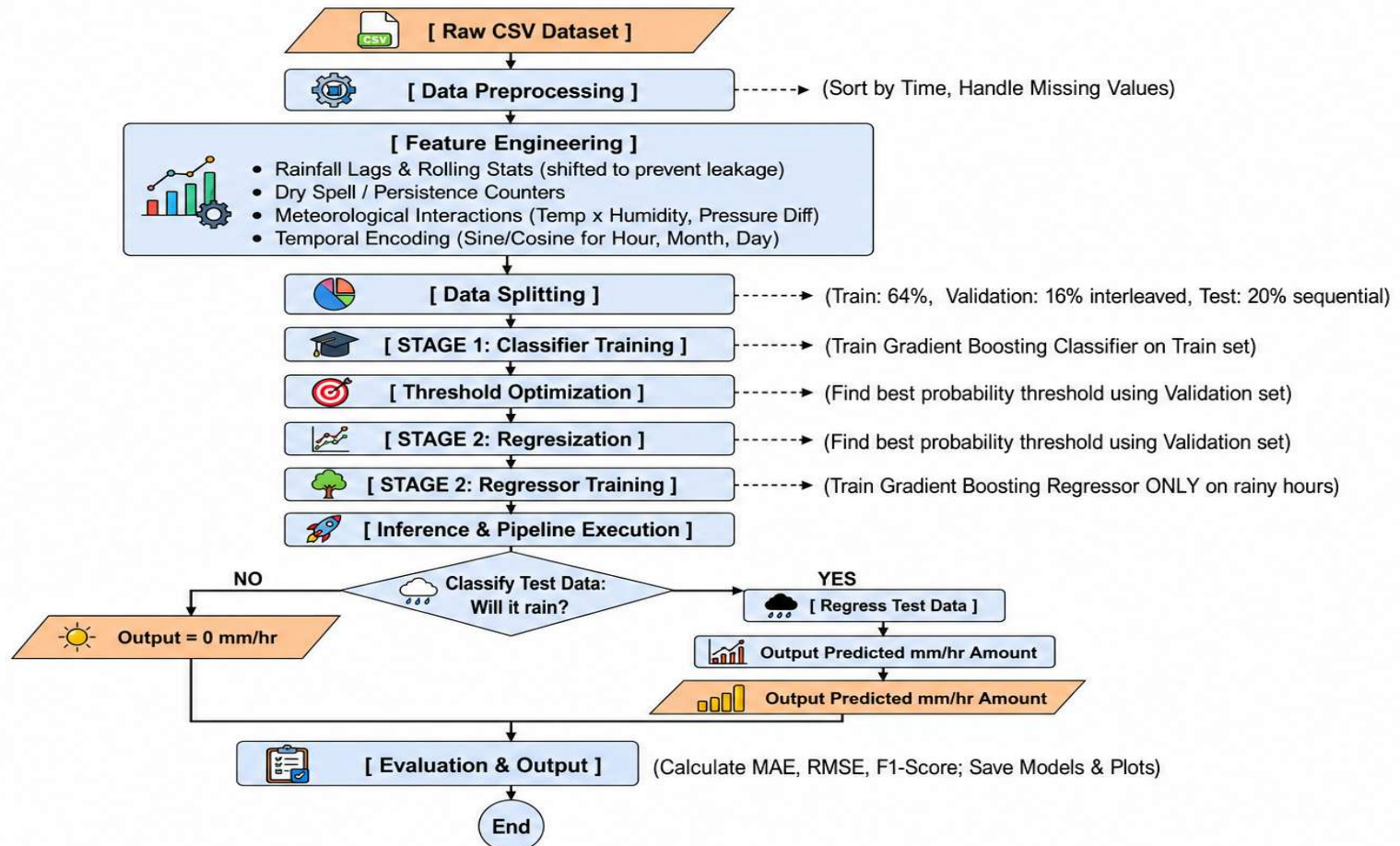


Figure-1

Block Diagram

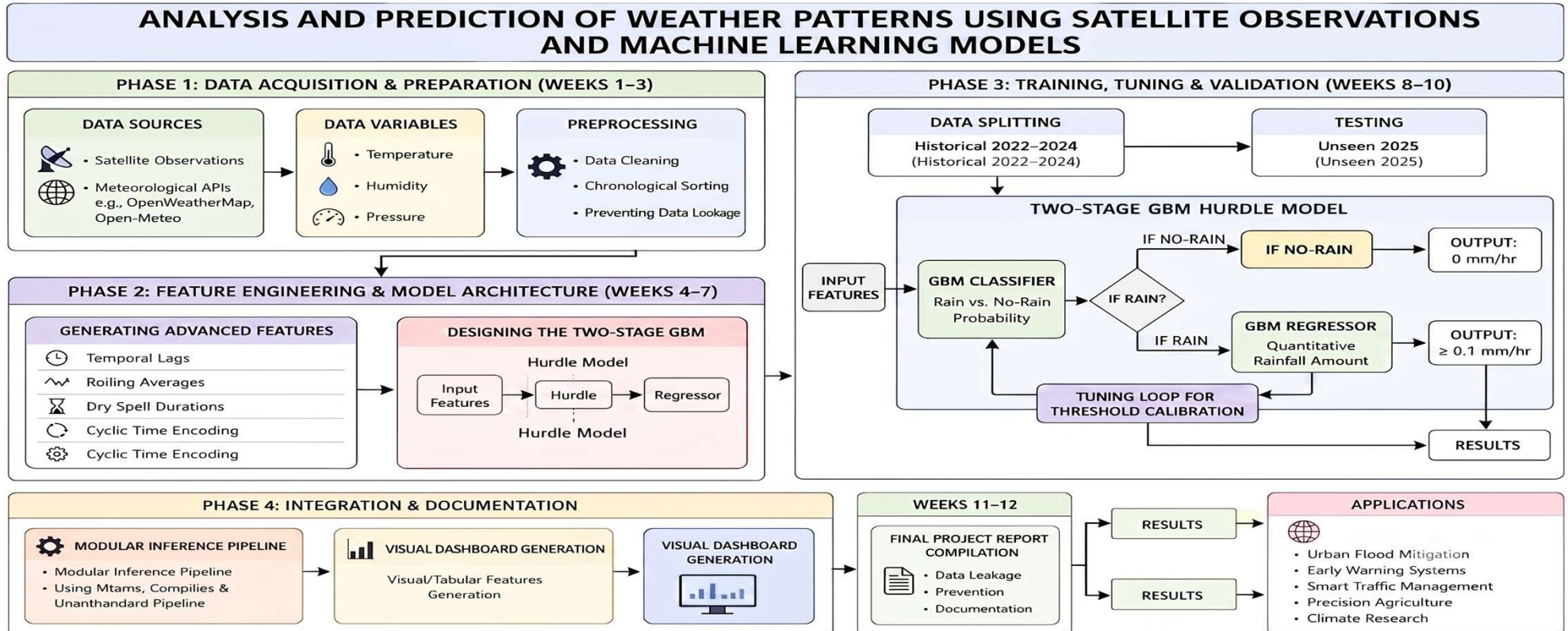


Figure-2

Hardware & Software Details

HARDWARE

NodeMCU
ESP 8266

GY -SHT30-
D Sensor

Output ML files

- Trained Classification Model
- Trained Regression Model
- Metadata and optimized threshold values

Streamlit

Joblib &
Request

Plotly

Software

Earthaccess
& Xarray

Numpy &
Pandas

Scikit-
learn &
Xgboost

Project Workflow: From Model Training to 7-Day Rainfall Forecast



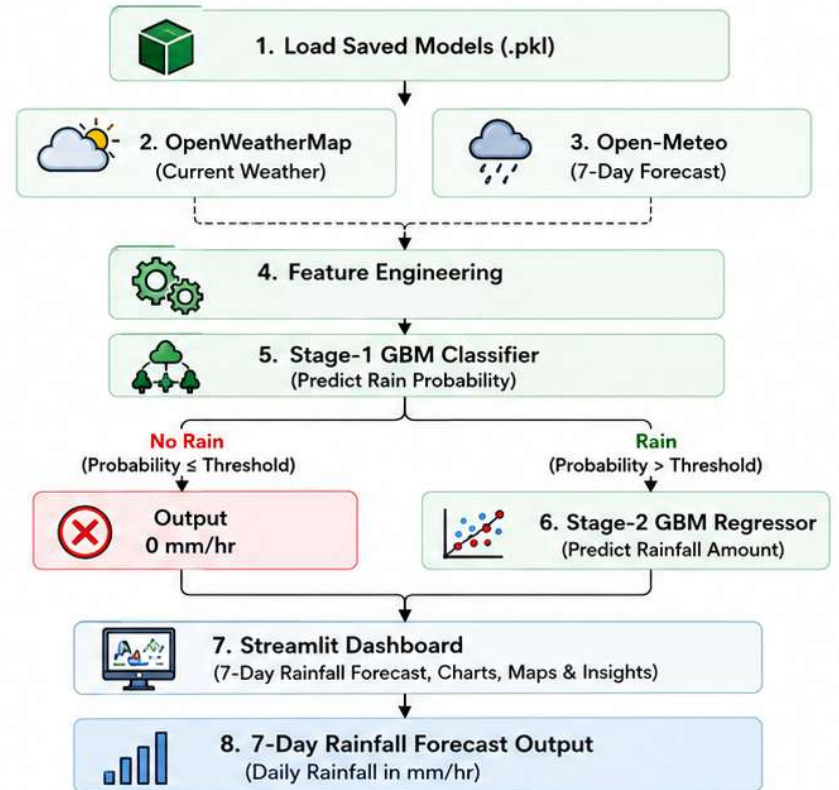
1 OFFLINE MODEL DEVELOPMENT (GDB_ML.ipynb)



Saved Models (.pkl)

- Classifier Model
- Regressor Model
- Threshold
- Feature Order

2 REAL-TIME FORECASTING (ML_integration.ipynb)



Accurate Localized
Rainfall Prediction



Supports Flood
Risk Mitigation



Actionable Insights for
Urban Decision Making



Real-Time 7-Day
Forecasting



Reliable, Scalable &
Data-Driven System

Pictures of the Prototype Model

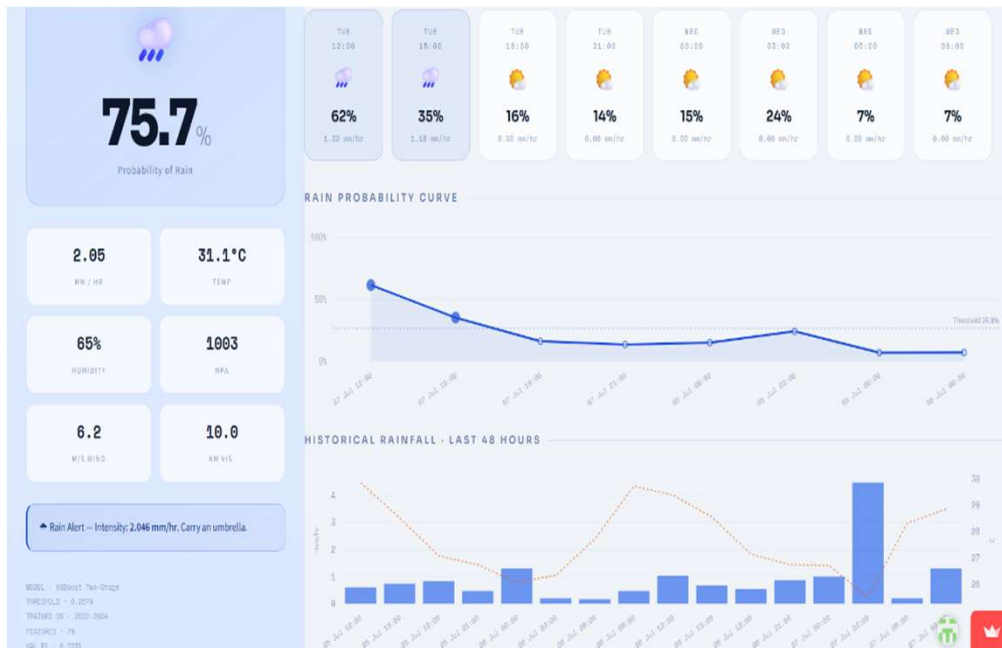


Figure-3 Web Dashboard

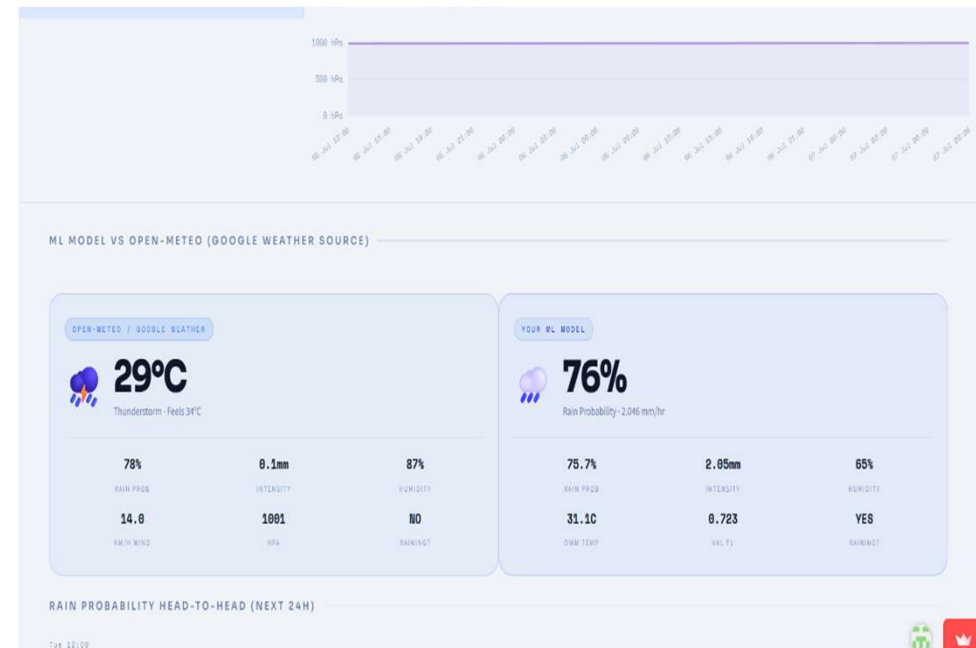


Figure-4 ML-Model Vs Open Meteo



Figure-5 Hardware Sensor Reading

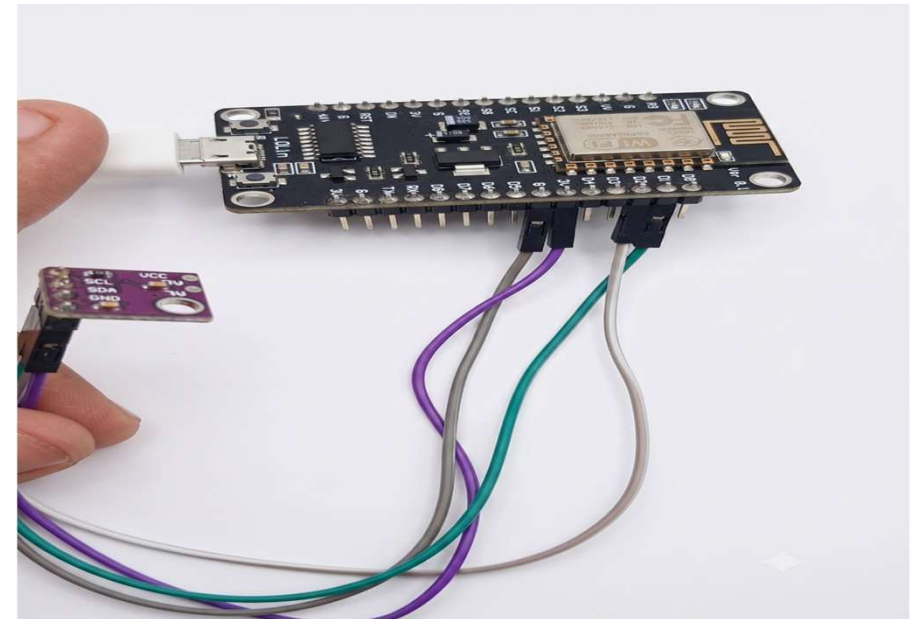


Figure-6 Hardware (ESP8266 & SHT30)

Experimental Result

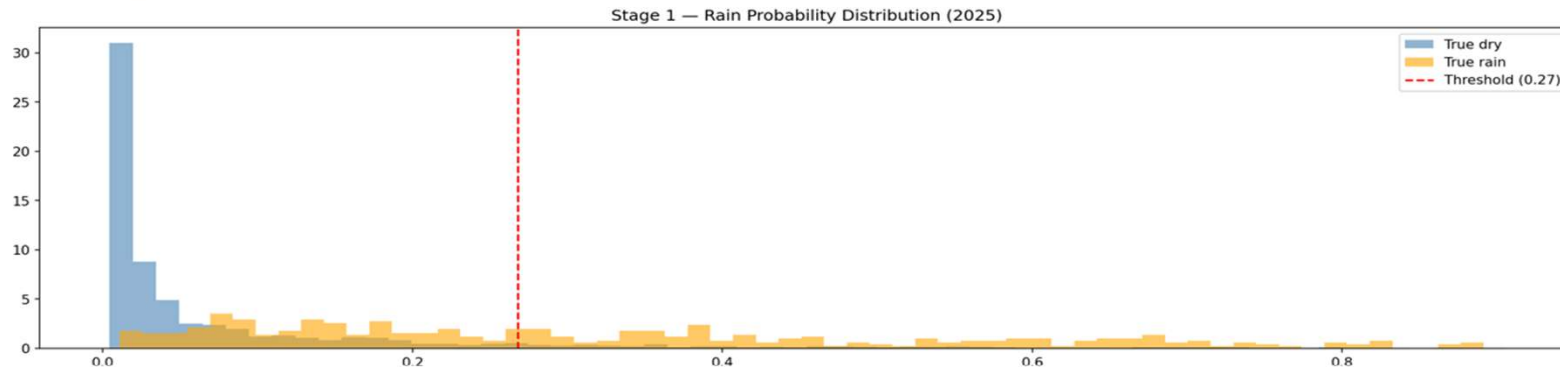


Figure-7 Stage 1 Classifier Probability Threshold

Kolkata 2025 — Out-of-Sample Evaluation (trained on 2022-2024)

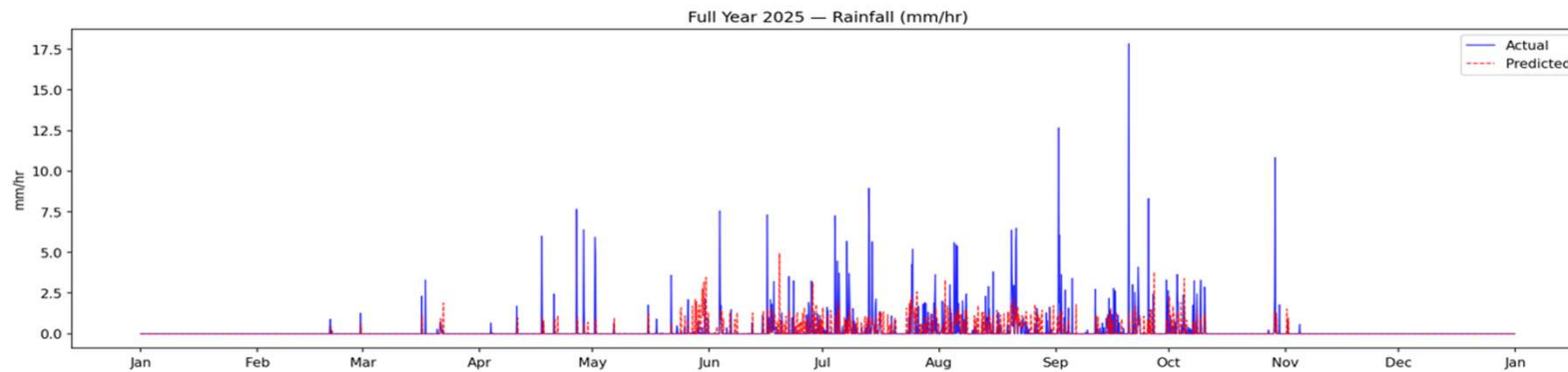


Figure-8 Full ML predication of 2025 Unseen Test data

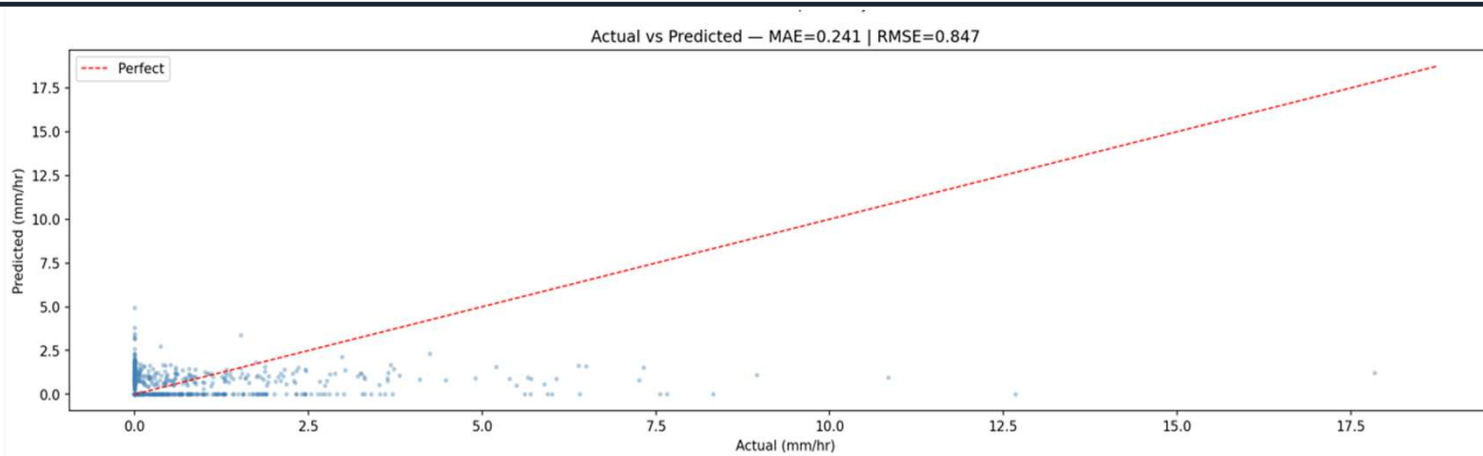


Figure-9 Actual Vs Predicated Scatter Plot

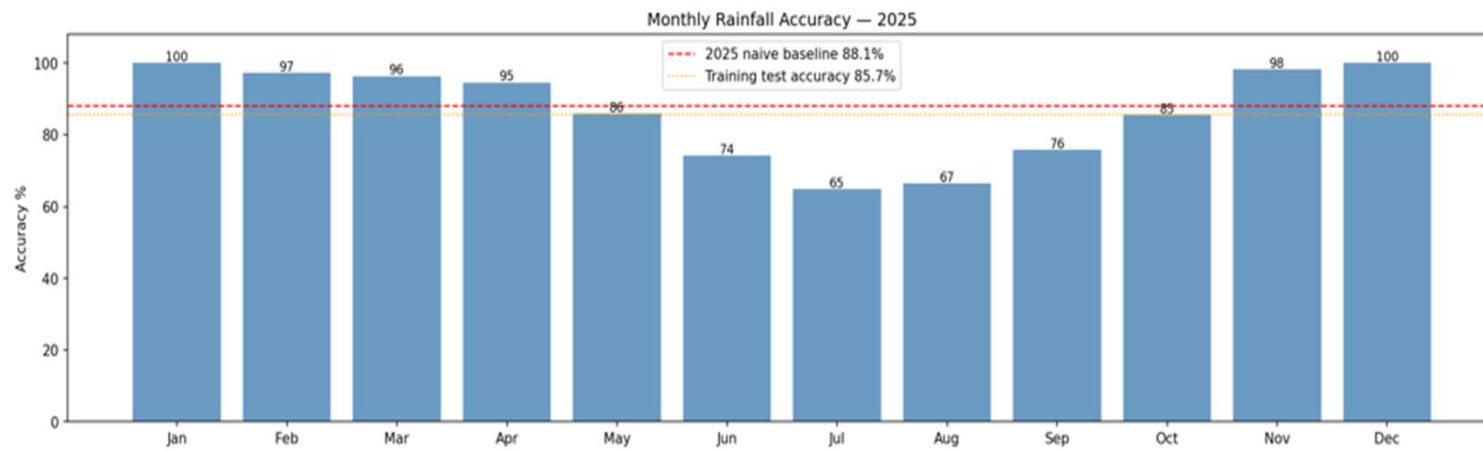


Figure-10 Monthly Accuracy Histogram

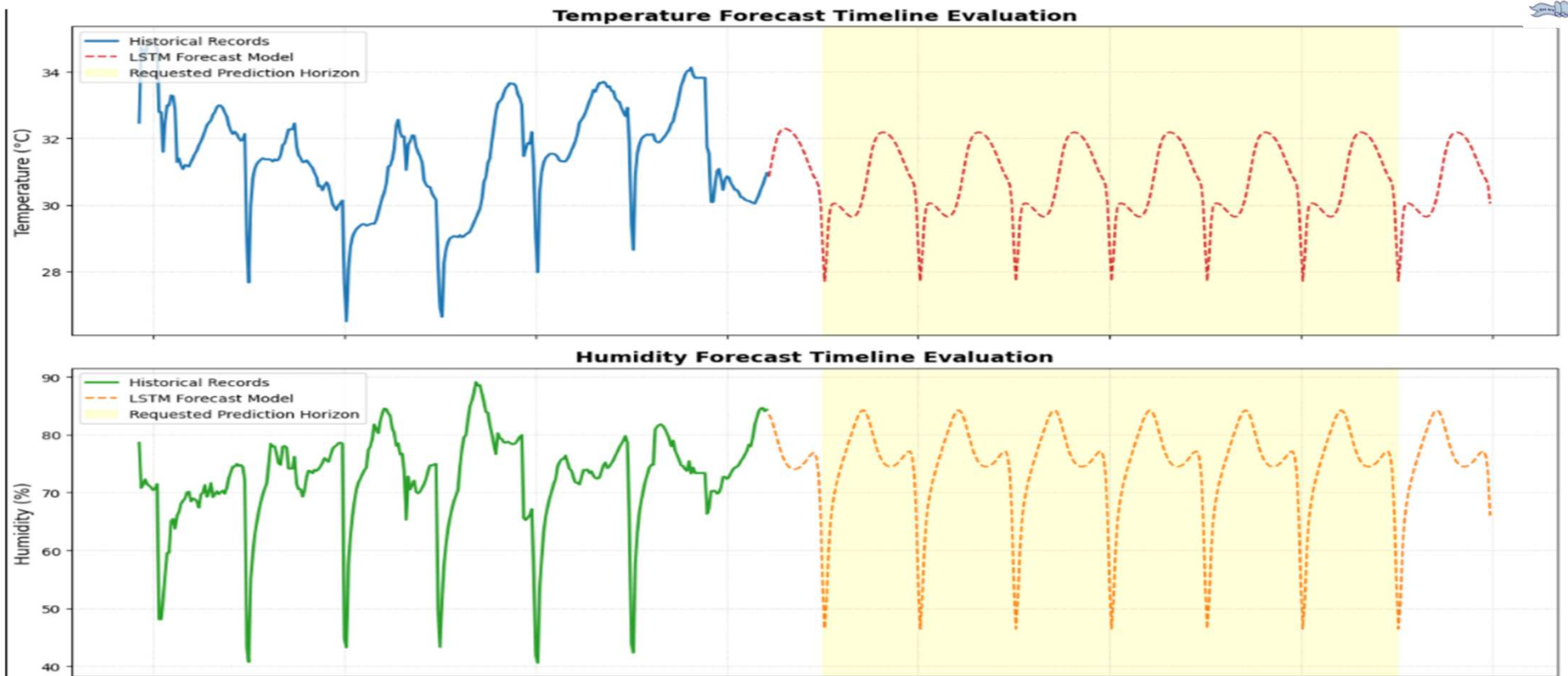


Figure-11 Hardware Statistical Performances



Analysis & Discussion of the results

ML MODEL STATS (predicting Rainfall intensity)

CATEGORY	EVALUATION METRIC	RESULT
Error Rates	MAE	0.4170 mm/hr
	RMSE	1.2902 mm/hr
Accuracy	Accuracy	81.58%
	F1- Score	0.716
Mean	Actual	4.68 mm/hr
	Predicted	0.93 mm/hr

Table-2 Training Data Stats for the (GBM) ML Model

CATEGORY	EVALUATION METRIC	RESULT
Error Rates	MAE	0.2388 mm/hr
	RMSE	0.8426 mm/hr
Accuracy	Accuracy	86.54%
	F1-Score	0.696
Mean	Actual	4.20 mm/hr
	Predicted	0.68 mm/hr

Table-3 Testing Stats of the (GBM) trained model



ML MODEL STATS (predicting Temperature and Humidity)

CATEGORY	EVALUATION METRIC	RESULT
Temperature	RMSE	0.8395 °C
Humidity	RMSE	8.8386 %

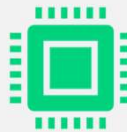
Table-4 Testing Data stats for the LSTM ML model

Future Scope



Deep Learning for Sequential Extraction:

Future research must focus on optimizing advanced Deep Learning (DL) architectures, like Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) networks or Temporal Convolutional Networks (TCNs)



Hyper-Local Nowcasting: Leveraging real-time data from IoT weather sensors deployed across different municipal zones in Kolkata to develop hyper-local, real-time nowcasting (0-3 hours) for rainfall.



Extreme Event Extrapolation: Future work will focus on integrating Extreme Value Theory (EVT) to ensure the model remains robust during severe climatic anomalies.



Cost of the prototype

Category	Description	Estimated Cost
Data Acquisition	Utilization of Open-Meteo & OpenWeatherMap APIs (Free tiers)	₹0
Software & Tools	Python, Scikit-learn, Pandas, Matplotlib (Open Source)	₹0
Compute Resources	Local Workstation usage	₹0
Hardware	Sensor Microconcontroller wire etc	₹400 ~ ₹600
Misc	Printing, binding, and incidental research costs	Minimal
Total		₹700-₹800 (approx.)

Table-5 Finance

Conclusion



Dual-stage Gradient Boosting Machine (GBM) architecture—utilizing a classifier to predict rain probability and a regressor for precipitation volume—effectively overcomes the overwhelming statistical bias of "no rain" hours.



Pairing wide-area remote sensing data from **NASA's MERRA-2 and GPM instruments** with a cascading machine learning ensemble optimizes tropical weather forecasting.



Delivers accurate, localized downpour **forecasts to support flood resilience, water resource management, traffic planning**, and early disaster risk reduction in Kolkata

References

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 - ❑ [2]Jagadeshwari Puttanapura, Monika Singh T., C. Kishor Kumar Reddy, and Srinath Doss, "Improvise Prediction of Rainfall using Random Forest Classifier Over Taiwan," *Proceedings of the 4th International Conference on Soft Computing for Security Applications (ICSCSA)*, IEEE, 2024, doi: **10.1109/ICSCSA64454.2024.00031**.
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 - ❑ [7] Priya A Nandini, Bhargavi Meenavalli, Adarsha Puttamreddy, Jatoth Meghana, Nilima Kataria, Lalita Gupta “Prediction of Rainfall using Random Forest”, 2022 IEEE International Students' Conference on Electrical, Electronics and Computer Science (SCEECS), 2022
 - ❑ [8] A. Chand and R. Nand, “Rainfall prediction using Artificial Neural Network in the South Pacific region,” 2019 IEEE Asia-Pacific Conference on Computer Science and Data Engineering (CSDE), Melbourne, VIC, Australia, 2019.
 - ❑ [9] M. Patel and A. Shah, “Feature Importance in Machine Learning with Explainable Artificial Intelligence (XAI) for Rainfall Prediction,” in ITM Web of Conferences, EDP Sciences, vol. 65, p. 03007, 2024.
 - ❑ [10] Zhang, Yushan, Kun Wu, Jinglin Zhang, Feng Zhang, Haixia Xiao, Fuchang Wang, Jianyin Zhou, Yi Song, and Liang Peng, “Estimating Rainfall with Multi-Resource Data over East Asia Based on Machine Learning”, Remote Sensing, 2021.
 - ❑ [11] Yang, Huang., George, P., Petropoulos., Qifeng, Lu., Yanfeng, Huo., Fu, Wang. “Precipitation Estimation Using FY-4B/AGRI Satellite Data Based on Random Forest.” Remote sensing, 2024
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